The All

SENSE EXPERIENCES

Sights

Sounds

Tastes

Smells

Bodily Perceptions

Thoughts, Feelings

MENTAL STATES

Common Mental States

Such as memory, stability, feeling tone (pleasant or unpleasant), will, and life force.

Plus either:

Unhealthy States
The three roots of:
GREED, HATRED, DELUSION
give rise to
worry, envy, rigidity, agitation, grasping, self-centeredness, aversion, fear, avarice, shamelessness, dullness, closed-mindedness, confusion, misperception, recklessness, and others.

Or:

Healthy States
The three roots of:
WISDOM, LOVE, GENEROSITY
give rise to
mindfulness, confidence, graciousness, modesty, joy, insight, flexibility, clarity, equanimity, adaptability, kindness, and others.

SENSE CONSCIOUSNESS

Eye Consciousness
Seeing

Ear Consciousness
Hearing

Tongue Consciousness
Tasting

Nose Consciousness
Smelling

Body Consciousness
Sensing

Mind Consciousness
Thinking, feeling, intuiting

The Five Hindrances

The Five Classic Challenges are called "hindrances" to clarity in Buddhist text.

1. Grasping: wanting, clinging, greed, wanting more (or something different) from what's present right now.
2. Aversion: fear, anger, hate, any form of pushing away.
3. Restlessness: jumpy energy, agitation.
4. Sloth and torpor: sleepy, sinking states of mind and body.
5. Doubt: a mind state that says, "It's no use; this will never work; I can't; maybe there's an easier way."

These are universal body-mind energies experienced by all humans. When we are caught in them, they make it difficult to see with wisdom and clarity. It is important to recognize that in themselves, they are not a "problem." The energies become "hindrances" because our conditioned habit is to be identified with them, or ignore, resist, judge or try to control them. And yet when met with mindfulness and care, these same energies become an immediate gateway to increased aliveness and spiritual awakening.

During sitting practice, if you encounter one of these challenging energies, it may be useful to name it silently to yourself, e.g., "grasping, grasping" or "fear, fear." If it is strong, rather than pulling away, let your intention be to bring your full attention to what is arising. Feel what is happening as sensations in your body, neither getting lost in the experience nor pushing it away. As indicated through the RAIN acronym, investigate what is arising and meet the experience with an intimate, compassionate attention. When it dissipates, return to the primary anchor of your meditation, or rest in "natural presence."

Sometimes the energy is too strong, and it is not wise or compassionate to try to stay present with it. This is particularly true if you have been traumatized and are experiencing deep fear or anger. If it feels like "too much," shift the attention to something that brings a sense of balance, safety, and/or love. You might open your eyes, remind yourself of where you are, listen to sounds, relax again through your body. You might bring to mind someone who loves and understands you, and sense their care surrounding you. You might reflect on the Buddha or the bodhisattva of compassion, Jesus, Great Spirit, your grandmother, your dog, or a favorite tree. You might offer phrases of lovingkindness to places of vulnerability. Meditate on any expression of loving presence that helps you feel less separate or afraid.

If any of these difficult emotional energies regularly overwhelms you, you might ask a teacher or therapist familiar with meditation to accompany you as you learn to navigate what feels most intense.

The Seven Factors of Enlightenment

1. Mindfulness
2. Investigation
3. Effort
4. Joy
5. Calm
6. Concentration
7. Equanimity

One of the clearest ways to describe the development of practice is the seven factors of enlightenment. These are the natural qualities of mind that the Buddha described as the constituents of a proper spiritual practice. A mind in which these factors are fully developed and balanced experiences freedom.

Three of these factors are energetic elements. These are investigation, an interested observation of what is happening; effort, which means the energy to be mindful and present; and rapture or joy, which manifests as bliss and a growing delight in the spiritual practice.

Three of these factors are stabilizing elements. They are concentration, one-pointedness of mind; tranquility, quietness of mind; and equanimity, wise detachment and balance of mind in the face of change.

The first factor is mindfulness, the key to practice. The development of mindfulness automatically develops all of the other factors. Mindfulness or loving awareness notices the experience of the present moment, and also brings the seven factors into proper balance.

All of the approaches to practice may be considered in the light of the development of these seven qualities of mind. Some will develop the energy and joy factors more rapidly or strongly. Others strengthen concentration or equanimity more quickly. No need to be concerned with the form of the practice or the words or style of the teaching. Simply see if it will lead to the development of the factors of enlightenment.

It all comes back to mind and heart. Mind/heart is the start and end of all spiritual work. One can examine a path to see what qualities of mind/heart are developed and see if that path will help to bring the factors of enlightenment further into balance. If so, then use it, remembering that getting caught in further opinions and comparisons of various practices can be a great obstacle to liberation. Relax. Do your own practice and honor those around you with love.

"Living Dharma: Teaching and Meditation Instructions" from *Twelve Theravada Masters* by Jack Kornfield

ABC List of Feelings

Donna Harris, Lifewalk Coaching & Counselling, www.lifewalk.ca

A Abandoned, absent-minded, absorbed, active, adamant, adaptable, adequate, adventurous, affected, affectionate, afraid, aggressive, aggravated, agitated, agony, alarmed, alert, alienated, almighty, aloof, altered, amazed, ambitious, ambivalent, amused, angry, animated, animosity, anguished, annoyed, anxious, appalled, apathetic, appreciative, apprehensive, ardent, argumentative, arrogant, ashamed, assertive, astonished, astounded, aversion, awed, awkward

B Bad, baffled, bashful, beat, beautiful, belittled, betrayed, belligerent, bereaved, bewildered, bitter, blissful, boastful, bold, bored, bossy, brave, bright, burdened, burnt out

C Calm, capable, captivated, careless, cautious, centered, chagrined, challenged, changeable, charmed, cheated, cheerful, childish, civilized, clear-headed, clever, coarse, cold, combative, comfortable, commonplace, compassionate, complaining, conceited, condemned, confident, confused, conspicuous, conscientious, competitive, considerate, contempt, contented, contrite, conventional, cool, cooperative, courageous, conservative, cowardly, cranky, cruel, crushed, curious, cynical

D Daring , dazed, dazzled, deceitful, defeated, defensive, dejected, delighted, demanding, dependable, dependent, depressed, desirous, desolate, despair, depleted, despondent, destructive, detached, determined, devastated, different, dignified, diminished, disappointed, disconnected, discontented, discreet, discombobulated, disconcerted, discouraged, disgusted, disgruntled, disheartened, dismayed, displeased, disorderly, dissatisfied, distracted, distraught, distressed, distrustful, disturbed, divided, dominant, dominated, dread, dreamy, dubious, dull

E Eager, easygoing, ecstatic, edgy, efficient, effeminate, egotistical, electrified, embarrasses, emotional, empathetic, empowered, enchanted, encouraged, energetic, enervated, engaged, engrossed, enlivened, enraged, enthralled, entranced, enterprising, enthusiastic, envious, evasive, equanimous, exasperated, excitable, excited, exhausted, exhilarated, expectant, exuberant, evil

F Fabulous, fair-minded, fascinated, fawning, fearful, feminine, fidgety, flustered, foolish, foreboding, forceful, foresighted, forgetful, forgiving, forlorn, formal, fragile, frank, frantic, frazzled, free, friendly, frightened, frivolous, frustrated, full, fulfilled, furious, fussy

G Guarded, generous, gentle, giddy, glad, gloomy, good, good natured, gratified, greedy, groovy, guilty, gullible

H Happy, hard, hate, headed, hard hearted, hasty, hateful, headstrong, heartbroken, heavenly, helpful, helpless, hesitant, high, homesick, honest, honoured, hopeless, horrible, horrified, hostile, humourless, hurried, hurt, hysterical, hyper

I Idealistic, ignored, imaginative, immature, immoral, immature, immortal, impatient, irresponsible, impatient, imposed-upon, impressed, independent, indignant, indifferent, individualistic, industrious, infantile, infuriated, ingenious, inhibited, insecure, inspired, intelligent, interested, intrigued, irritated, intimate, intolerant, inventive, invigorated, involved, irked, irate, irritable, irritated, isolated

J Jealous, jittery, jolly, joyful, joyous, jovial, jubilant, jumpy

K Keen, kicky, kind

L Lazy, lecherous, left-out, leisurely, leery, lethargic, licentious, listless, lively, livid, logical, lonely, longing, lost, lovable, loving, low, loyal

M Mad, mannerly, masculine, mature, maudlin, mean, meek, melancholy, mellow, mild, mischievous, miserable, mistrustful, moderated, modest, moody, mortified, moved, mystical, mystified

N Nagging, natural, naughty, nervous, nice, noisy, nostalgic, numb, nutty

O Obliging, obnoxious, obsessed, open, optimistic, opinionated, opposed, original, outgoing, organized, outspoken, overwhelmed, outraged

P Pained, painstaking, panicked, parsimonious, passionate, patient, peaceful, peculiar, perplexed, persecuted, perturbed, preserving, persistent, pessimistic, petrified, pitiful, pleasant, pleased, poised, polished, practical, praising, precarious, precise, prejudiced, preoccupied, pressured, pretty, prim, prissy, progressive, proper, proud, prudish, puzzled

Q Quarrelsome, quiet

R Radiant, rapturous, rational, rattled, real, realistic, reasonable, rebellious, reckless, reflective, refreshed, regretful, rejected, rejuvenated, relaxed, reliable, relieved, remorseful, removed, repulsed, resentful, reserved, resourceful, responsible, resentful, reserved, resourceful, responsible, rested, restless, restored, reverent, revived, rewarded, righteous, rigid, rude

S Sad, safe, sarcastic, sated, satisfied, scared, screwed-up, secure, self-assured, selfish, self-centered, self-confident, self-conscious, self-controlled, self-denying, self-pitying, self-punishing, self-seeking sensitive, sentimental, serene, serious, servile, settled, severe, sexy, shaky, shallow, sharp-witted, shiftless, shocked, show-offish, shrewd, shy, silent, silly, simple, sincere, skeptical, sleepy, slipshod, slow, sly, smug, sneaky, snobbish, sociable, soft-hearted, solemn, sophisticated, sorrowful, spendthrift, spineless, spellbound, spiteful, spontaneous, spunky, stable, startled, steady, stern, still, stimulated, stingy, stolid, stressed, strangled, strong, stubborn, stupid, stunned, stupid, stunned, submissive, suffering, sulky, superstitious, sure, surprised, suspicious, sympathetic

T Tactful, tactless, talkative, temper mental, tempted, tenacious, tender, tense, tentative, terrible, terrified, tenacious, thankful, thankless, thorough, thoughtful, threatened, thrilled, thrifty, thwarted, tickled, timid, tired, tolerant, torn, touched, touchy, tough, tranquil, trapped, troubled, trusting

U Ugly, unaffected, unambitious, unassuming, uncomfortable, undependable, understanding, uneasy, unemotional, unexcitable, unfriendly, unhappy, uninhibited, unintelligent, uninterested, unkind, unrealistic, unsettled, unscrupulous, unselfish, unsettled, unstable, upset

V Vehement, versatile, vibrant, vindictive, violent, vital, vivacious, vulnerable

W Warm, wary, weak, weary, weepy, whiny, wholesome, wicked, wholesome, wicked, wild, withdrawn, wise, wistful, wonder, worn out, worried, wretched

X X-rated

Y Young

Z Zany, zealous, zippy